shall see, the British would have to make great efforts to get reliable information about this land in the nineteenth century. For now, the Europeans needed to find out about more about the geography of the subcontinent itself. Indeed, knowledge of India’s interiors remained quite basic except for major trade routes. This would change with the Battle of Plassey in 1757 where the troops of the English East India Company, led by Robert Clive, decisively defeated Siraj-ud-Daulah, the Nawab of Bengal. With this victory, for the first time, a European power came to control a major province. Soon, the British would be acquiring large territories and sustaining campaigns in the deep interiors of the country. Accurate maps were more important than ever. Enter Colonel James Rennel.